

THEME 1 · B1.1

School Life

Students of different countries, nationalities, and languages

Capitals of their countries, and tourist attractions

Activities in their capitals and countries

National days and celebrations

Warm-up

Look at the title: School Life. What do you think we will talk about in this theme? Tell your partner two ideas.

By the end of this theme...

1. I can introduce yourself, your nationality and your country
2. I can ask and answer about capitals, languages and tourist attractions
3. I can say what you can and can't do, see or visit in your country
4. I can interview a classmate about their country for a class presentation

VOCABULARY

New words

20 target words

nationality

noun · /,næʃə'næləti/



milliyet, uyruk

My nationality is Turkish — I'm from Türkiye.

country

noun · /'kʌntri/



ülke

Azerbaijan is a country in the Caucasus.

capital city

noun phrase · /'kæpɪtəl 'sɪti/



başkent

Warsaw is the capital city of Poland.

official language

noun phrase · /ə'fɪʃl 'læŋɡwɪdʒ/



resmi dil

Hungarian is the official language of Hungary.

population

noun · /ˌpɒpjʊˈleɪʃn/



nüfus

Budapest has a population of about 1.7 million.

currency

noun · /'kʌrənsi/



para birimi

The currency in Poland is the złoty.

neighbouring country

noun phrase · /'neɪbərɪŋ 'kʌntri/



komşu ülke

Türkiye has several neighbouring countries, like Greece and Bulgaria.

tourist attraction

noun phrase · /'tʊərɪst ə'trækʃn/



turistik yer, cazibe merkezi

The old castle is the city's most famous tourist attraction.

sightseeing

noun · /'saɪtsiːɪŋ/



gezip görme, tur atma

We went sightseeing around the old town all afternoon.

monument

noun · /'mɒnjumənt/



anıt

There's a monument to the country's independence in the main square.

castle

noun · /'kɑːsl/



kale, şato

You can see the whole city from the top of the castle.

landmark

noun · /'ləndmɑ:k/



simge yapı, önemli yer

The tower is the most famous landmark in the capital.

souvenir

noun · /,su:və'nɪə(r)/



hediyelik eşya

I bought a small souvenir from the museum shop.

national dish

noun phrase · /'næʃnəl dɪʃ/



millî yemek

Gulash is often called the national dish of Hungary.

national day

noun phrase · /'næʃnəl deɪ/



millî gün, bayram

Every country celebrates its own national day with special events.

exchange student

noun phrase · /ɪks'tʃeɪndʒ 'stju:dnt/



değişim öğrencisi

Our class welcomed an exchange student from Hungary this term.

pen pal

noun phrase · /'pen pæl/



mektup/yazışma arkadaşı

My pen pal in Poland writes to me about life in Warsaw.

flag

noun · /flæg/



bayrak

Azerbaijan's flag has blue, red and green stripes.

Azerbaijani

adjective / noun · /,æzəbaɪ'dʒɑːni/



Azerbaycanlı / Azericesi

Leyla is Azerbaijani, and she speaks Azerbaijani at home.

Polish / Hungarian

adjective / noun · /'pəʊlɪʃ/ /hʌŋ'ɡeəriən/



Polonyalı-Lehçe / Macar-Macarca

Kasia is Polish and Zoltán is Hungarian, but they both speak good English.

Quick game · What's the word?

“simge yapı, önemli yer”

a landmark

b population

c flag

Quick game · What's the word?

“para birimi”

a currency

b national day

c monument

Quick game · What's the word?

“bayrak”

a capital city

b castle

c flag

Quick game · What's the word?

“Polonyalı-Lehçe / Macar-Macarca”

a flag

b Polish / Hungarian

c capital city

Quick game · What's the word?

“anıt”

a currency

b monument

c exchange student

Quick game · What's the word?

“milliyet, uyruk”

a landmark

b population

c nationality

GRAMMAR

To be (am/is/are): nationality and origin

Notice

I **am** Turkish and I **am** from Balıkesir.

Kasia **is** Polish. She **is** from Warsaw.

We **are** students of different nationalities, but we **aren't** from the same country.

Is Zoltán Hungarian? — Yes, he **is**. / No, he **isn't**.

Which form of 'be' goes with I, with he/she, and with we/they? How do we make it negative and a question?

Complete the rule

Look at the Notice sentences again. Complete the rule with the words in the box.

am**is****are****Is / Are**

Complete the rule

With I, we use _____.

✓ am

Complete the rule

With he, she or it, we use _____ .

✓ is

Complete the rule

With we, you or they, we use _____ .

✓ are

Complete the rule

In a question, we start with _____ + subject.

✓ Is / Are / Is/Are

The rule

We use 'to be' (am/is/are) in the present to talk about identity, nationality and where someone is from. Use am with I, is with he/she/it, and are with we/you/they. Negative: add 'not' (isn't, aren't). Question: put the 'be' verb before the subject.

TR 'To be' (am/is/are) şimdiki zamanda kimlik, milliyet ve nereli olduğumuzu anlatmak için kullanılır. I ile am, he/she/it ile is, we/you/they ile are kullanılır. Olumsuzda 'not' eklenir (isn't, aren't); soruda be fiili öznenen önce gelir.

When? We use this to introduce ourselves, our classmates and exchange students, and to say our nationality, country and where we are from.

TR Kendimizi, sınıf arkadaşlarımızı ve değişim öğrencilerini tanıtırken; milliyet, ülke ve nereli olduğumuzu söylerken kullanırız.

Build sentences · Example

I + Turkish + from Balıkesir

I am Turkish. I am from Balıkesir.

Build sentences

Kasia

+

Polish

+

from Warsaw

Kasia is Polish. She is from Warsaw.

Build sentences

we

+

not / from the same country

We aren't from the same country.

Build sentences

? / Zoltán

+

Hungarian

Is Zoltán Hungarian?

Build sentences

Leyla and Kasia

+

not / from Türkiye

Leyla and Kasia aren't from Türkiye.

Build sentences

? / you

+

an exchange student

Are you an exchange student?

Your turn

Write four sentences about yourself and one classmate: your nationality, where you are from, and one thing you are not.

I am...

I am from...

My classmate is...

We aren't...

Form

POSITIVE

I am Turkish.
She is from Warsaw.

NEGATIVE

We aren't from the same
country.
He isn't Polish.

QUESTION

Is Zoltán Hungarian?
Are you an exchange
student?

SHORT ANSWERS

Yes, he is. / No, he isn't.
Yes, we are. / No, we
aren't.

Error detective

She are Polish.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **She is Polish.**

Error detective

I is from Türkiye.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ I am from Türkiye.

A · Choose the correct option.

I _____ Turkish, and I _____ from Balıkesir.

a am / am

b is / is

c are / are

A · Choose the correct option.

Kasia _____ Polish.

a am

b is

c are

A · Choose the correct option.

We _____ from the same country.

a isn't

b aren't

c am not

A · Choose the correct option.

_____ Zoltán Hungarian?

a Do

b Is

c Are

B · Complete with am/is/are.

Leyla and Kasia _____ (not) from Türkiye.

✓ **aren't / are not**

B · Complete with am/is/are.

_____ you an exchange student?

✓ Are

C · Judge the sentence.

He are from Hungary.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **He is from Hungary.**

C · Judge the sentence.

We are students of different nationalities.

a Correct

b Incorrect

Dialogue · Complete with am/is/are.

A: Hi! _____ you new here?

✓ Are

Dialogue · Complete with am/is/are.

B: Yes, I _____. I _____ from Azerbaijan.

✓ **am / am**

Dialogue · Complete with am/is/are.

Make a question.

is

your

Baku

capital

city

?

✓ **Is your capital city Baku?**

GRAMMAR

Can: possibility, opportunity and ability

Notice

In Istanbul, you **can** visit lots of famous mosques and palaces.

Kasia **can** speak Polish, English and a little German.

You **can't** see the northern lights in Türkiye — it's too far south.

Can you visit the capital by train? — Yes, you **can**.

**Which sentences talk about what is possible to do in a place? Which talk about a language/skill ability?
How do we make 'can' negative and a question?**

Complete the rule

Look at the Notice sentences again. Complete the rule with the words in the box.

can**can't****Can****base verb**

Complete the rule

' _____ ' shows something is possible or that someone has the ability to do it.

✓ can

Complete the rule

The negative is '_____', for things that are not possible.

✓ **can't**

Complete the rule

In a question, ' _____ ' comes before the subject.

✓ Can

Complete the rule

After can/can't, we always use the _____ (no -s, no 'to').

✓ **base verb**

The rule

We use 'can' to talk about possibility or opportunity in a place, and about ability (including language skills). Negative: can't. Question: Can + subject + base verb? Always use the base verb after can/can't.

TR 'Can' bir yerde neyin mümkün olduğunu (imkan/fırsat) ve bir yeteneği anlatmak için kullanılır. Olumsuzda 'can't', soruda 'can' özneden önce gelir. Can'dan sonra fiilin yalın hâli kullanılır.

When? We use this to say what you can see or do in a country or city, and to talk about language skills and other abilities.

TR Bir ülkede/şehirde nelerin görülüp yapılabileceğini, ve bir dili/beceriye ne kadar iyi bildiğimizi anlatırken kullanırız.

Build sentences · Example

in Istanbul

+

visit

+

famous mosques and palaces

In Istanbul, you can visit famous mosques and palaces.

Build sentences

Kasia

+

Speak

+

Polish, English and a little German

Kasia can speak Polish, English and a little German.

Build sentences

you + not / see + the northern lights in Türkiye

You can't see the northern lights in Türkiye.

Build sentences

? / you

+

visit

+

the capital by train

Can you visit the capital by train?

Build sentences

tourists

+

climb

+

the old castle tower

Tourists can climb the old castle tower.

Build sentences

? / we

+

try

+

the national dish at the festival

Can we try the national dish at the festival?

Your turn

Write three sentences with can/can't about your own country: one about a tourist attraction, one about a language ability, and one negative sentence.

In my country, you can...

I can speak...

You can't...

Form

POSITIVE

You can visit the old town
on foot.
She can speak three
languages.

NEGATIVE

You can't see the sea from
the capital.
He can't speak Hungarian
yet.

QUESTION

Can you visit the castle at
night?
Can she speak
Azerbaijani?

SHORT ANSWERS

Yes, you can. / No, you
can't.
Yes, she can. / No, she
can't.

Error detective

She can to speak three languages.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **She can speak three languages.**

Error detective

She cans speak Polish.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **She can speak Polish.**

A · Choose the correct option.

In our capital, you _____ visit a famous old castle.

a can

b is

c are

A · Choose the correct option.

Kasia _____ speak Polish and English.

a cans

b can

c is can

A · Choose the correct option.

You _____ see the sea from our capital — it's inland.

a can

b can't

c isn't

A · Choose the correct option.

_____ you visit the tourist attraction by bus?

a Do

b Can

c Are

B · Complete with can/can't.

In Baku, you _____ (see) the famous Flame Towers.

✓ can see

B · Complete with can/can't.

Zoltán _____ (not/speak) Turkish, but he _____ (speak) English very well.

✓ **can't speak / can speak**

C · Judge the sentence.

You can to visit the monument for free.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **You can visit the monument for free.**

C · Judge the sentence.

Tourists can try the national dish at the festival.

a Correct

b Incorrect

Dialogue · Complete with can/can't.

A: _____ you tell me about a tourist attraction in your country?

✓ **Can**

Dialogue · Complete with can/can't.

B: Sure! You _____ visit our biggest castle — it's 800 years old.

✓ **can**

Dialogue · Complete with can/can't.

Make a question about ability.

you

other

can

languages

speak

any

?

✓ **Can you speak any other languages?**

READING

My New Pen Pal from Poland

Before you read

1. Look at the title. What do you think this blog post is about?
2. Guess: what three things might Elif ask her new pen pal about?

MY NEW PEN PAL FROM POLAND · 1 / 5

Hi, everyone! My name is Elif, and I'm a student at a school in Balıkesir, Türkiye. This month, our class started an international pen-pal project, and I'm so excited — my pen pal is Kasia, and she's from Poland!

MY NEW PEN PAL FROM POLAND · 2 / 5

Kasia is Polish, and she is from Warsaw, the capital city of Poland. In her first email, she told me that Warsaw's official language is Polish, but she can also speak good English and a little German. I told her that I am Turkish, and my nearest big city is İzmir.

MY NEW PEN PAL FROM POLAND · 3 / 5

Kasia says that in Warsaw, you can visit the Old Town, with its colourful buildings and the famous Royal Castle. You can also see a huge monument called the Palace of Culture and Science from almost anywhere in the city! She sent me a photo of the castle — it looks amazing.

MY NEW PEN PAL FROM POLAND · 4 / 5

I wrote back and told her about my own country. I explained that Ankara is the capital of Türkiye, but I live near İstanbul, where you can visit incredible mosques, palaces and the famous Grand Bazaar. I also told her about our national day, the 29th of October, when we celebrate the founding of the Turkish Republic.

MY NEW PEN PAL FROM POLAND · 5 / 5

Kasia and I are already planning to be video-call friends.
We aren't in the same country, but with a pen pal like Kasia,
the world feels a little smaller — and a lot more interesting!

While you read

What is the text mainly about?

a A trip to Poland

b Elif's new international pen pal

c How to learn Polish

While you read

What is Kasia's nationality?

a Turkish

b Hungarian

c Polish

While you read

What is the capital city of Poland?

a Warsaw

b Kraków

c Gdańsk

While you read

According to the text, what can you visit in Warsaw?

a The Grand Bazaar

b The Old Town and the Royal Castle

c The Flame Towers

While you read

Elif and Kasia are from the same country.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Elif and Kasia aren't from the same country — Elif is Turkish and Kasia is Polish.**

While you read

Why does Elif say the world feels 'a little smaller'?

a

Because she is moving to Poland

b

Because having a pen pal connects her to another country

c

Because Poland and Türkiye are very close

After you read

1. If you had a pen pal from another country, what would you tell them about your country first? Write two sentences.
2. Compare Elif's city with Kasia's city. Find one similarity and one difference.

READING

International Day at Our School

Before you read

1. What do you think happens on an 'International Day' at a school?
2. Guess two things students might do to celebrate other countries at school.

INTERNATIONAL DAY AT OUR SCHOOL · 1 / 5

Every spring, our school celebrates International Day, and it's one of my favourite events of the year. Students from different classes prepare a small stand about a country — its flag, capital city, nationality, and one famous tourist attraction.

INTERNATIONAL DAY AT OUR SCHOOL · 2 / 5

This year, my group chose Azerbaijan. We learned that the capital of Azerbaijan is Baku, and that Azerbaijani is the official language there. We found out that in Baku, you can see the famous Flame Towers, which light up in different colours at night. We also made a poster with the flag and some facts about the population.

INTERNATIONAL DAY AT OUR SCHOOL · 3 / 5

Other groups presented Hungary and Poland. The Hungarian group explained that Budapest is the capital of Hungary, and that you can go sightseeing along the Danube River. The Polish group talked about Warsaw's Old Town and even brought a small national dish to try — everyone loved it!

INTERNATIONAL DAY AT OUR SCHOOL · 4 / 5

In the afternoon, each group gave a short presentation about their country. We answered questions like 'Can you tell us about a national day in this country?' and 'What can tourists do there?' It was a great chance to practise speaking and to learn about the world at the same time.

INTERNATIONAL DAY AT OUR SCHOOL · 5 / 5

At the end of the day, our teacher said that International Day helps us understand that although we come from different countries and speak different languages, we can still learn from each other and be good friends.

While you read

What is International Day at this school?

a A sports competition

b A day when students
present facts about
different countries

c A national exam

While you read

What is the capital of Azerbaijan?

a Baku

b Warsaw

c Budapest

While you read

What can tourists see in Baku, according to the text?

a The Royal Castle

b The Flame Towers

c The Grand Bazaar

While you read

What did the Hungarian group say you can do in Budapest?

a

Go sightseeing along
the Danube River

b

Visit a famous castle

c

Try a national dish

While you read

Each group only made a poster and did not speak to the class.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Each group also gave a short presentation and answered questions.**

While you read

What does the teacher's final comment suggest?

a

Learning about other countries can build friendship and understanding

b

International Day is not very useful

c

Students should only study their own country

After you read

1. If your school had an International Day, which country would you choose to present?
Why?
2. Write two sentences about what tourists can do in your own country or city.

LISTENING

A Video Call with a New Friend

Before you listen

1. You will hear a video call between Elif (from Türkiye) and Kasia (from Poland).
2. Guess: what three questions might they ask each other about their countries?

A Video Call with a New Friend

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

Elif Hi, Kasia! It's so nice to finally see you! I'm Elif, and I'm from Türkiye.

Kasia Hi, Elif! Nice to meet you too. I'm Kasia, and I'm Polish — I'm from Warsaw.

Elif Warsaw is the capital, isn't it? What's it like there?

Kasia Yes, it is! It's a big, busy city. You can visit the Old Town and see the Royal Castle — it's beautiful at night.

Elif That sounds amazing. Can you speak any other languages besides Polish?

Kasia Yes, I can speak English and a little German. What about you — what's your capital?

Elif Our capital is Ankara, but I live near İstanbul. You can visit incredible mosques and palaces there.

Kasia Wow, I'd love to see that one day! Can we talk again next week?

Elif Of course we can! Let's plan our International Day presentation together too.

While you listen

What is Kasia's nationality?

a Turkish

b Hungarian

c Polish

While you listen

What is the capital of Poland?

a Warsaw

b Kraków

c Berlin

While you listen

What languages can Kasia speak?

a Only Polish

b Polish, English and a little German

c Polish and Turkish

While you listen

What can you visit near İstanbul, according to Elif?

a The Royal Castle

b Mosques and palaces

c The Flame Towers

While you listen

Elif and Kasia decide never to talk again.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Elif and Kasia plan to talk again next week.**

After you listen

1. Have you ever spoken to someone from another country online? What did you talk about?
2. Write two questions you would like to ask an exchange student about their country.

LISTENING

Planning the International Day Presentation

Before you listen

1. You will hear two students planning their International Day presentation about Azerbaijan.
2. Predict: what information do you think they need to include?

Planning the International Day Presentation

Ses kaydı yakında — transkripti öğretmen okuyabilir.

Deniz So, for International Day, we're presenting Azerbaijan. First, can you find out the capital city?

Elif Yes, I can check that tonight. I think it's Baku, but I'll confirm it.

Deniz Great. We also need the nationality and the official language — Azerbaijani, right?

Elif Right. And we should say what tourists can do there — I read you can see the Flame Towers in Baku.

Deniz Perfect, let's add that. Can you also find a fact about their national day?

Elif Sure, I can look that up too. Can you make the poster with the flag and the map?

Deniz Yes, I can do that tomorrow. Let's meet at break time to put it all together.

Elif Sounds good — see you at break!

While you listen

Which country are Deniz and Elif presenting?

a Poland

b Hungary

c Azerbaijan

While you listen

What does Elif say tourists can see in Baku?

a The Royal Castle

b The Flame Towers

c The Old Town

While you listen

What is Deniz going to make?

a A video

b A poster with the flag
and map

c A national dish

Give 10 seconds to think. Students show 1, 2 or 3 fingers for a, b, c. Then reveal. / 10 sn düşünme süresi; öğrenciler parmakla oy verir, sonra cevabı açın.

While you listen

Elif can't find out any information tonight.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Elif can find out the capital city and a national day fact tonight.**

While you listen

When will they meet to finish the presentation?

a At break time

b After school

c Next week

After you listen

1. If you planned an International Day presentation, which country would you choose?
Why?
2. Write one sentence with 'can' about something tourists can do in a country you know.

SPEAKING

Guess My Country

Think of a country. Walk around the class and answer your classmates' yes/no questions with 'to be' and 'can' so they can guess your country. Then guess theirs.

1. Secretly choose a country you know something about.
2. Find a partner and let them ask up to 5 yes/no questions with 'is/are' or 'can'.
3. Answer honestly with short answers.
4. Swap roles, then find a new partner.
5. After 4-5 rounds, share one interesting guess with the class.

Is it in Europe?

Can you see the sea from the capital?

Are people from this country called...?

Yes, it is. / No, it isn't. / Yes, you can. / No, you can't.

SUPPORT

Give students a list of sample questions before they start.

CORE

5 rounds of guessing with a partner.

EXTENSION

Fast finishers add one extra clue using 'can' about a tourist attraction.

SPEAKING

International School — Interview a Classmate

Interview a partner about their country, nationality, capital, a tourist attraction and a national day (real or invented, for creative-writing purposes). Take notes, then prepare to present your partner to the class as part of the 'International School' presentation.

1. In pairs, take turns asking the interview questions and noting the answers.
2. Check spelling of country/capital names together.
3. Prepare 4–5 sentences introducing your partner and their country.
4. Practise your short presentation with your partner.
5. Present your partner to a small group or the whole class.

What's your nationality?

What's the capital of your country?

What can tourists do or see there?

This is [name] from [country]. He/She is... You can visit...

SUPPORT

Give a question and sentence-starter card for lower-level students.

CORE

Full interview + a short presentation about your partner.

EXTENSION

Fast finishers add one extra sentence with 'can' about a national day activity.

WRITING

My Country Fact File

Write a short fact file about your own country (or an invented country, for creative-writing purposes) for an international pen pal. Include your nationality, capital city, official language, and at least two things tourists can do or see there.

1. Choose a title for your fact file, e.g. 'All About Türkiye'.
2. Note your nationality, capital city and official language.
3. List two or three things tourists can see or do.
4. Add one sentence about a national day or celebration.
5. Check your grammar and punctuation.

nationality

capital city

official language

tourist attraction

population

national day

I am...

The capital of my country is...

You can...

We celebrate...

WRITING

A Postcard from a Tourist Attraction

Imagine you are visiting a famous tourist attraction in another country (real or invented, for creative-writing purposes). Write a postcard to a classmate describing where you are, what it's like, and what visitors can do there.

1. Choose a tourist attraction and a country for your postcard.
2. Say where you are and what nationality the local people are.
3. Describe the place using 'to be'.
4. Say two things visitors can do or see there using 'can'.
5. End with a friendly closing line.

tourist attraction

sightseeing

monument

castle

landmark

souvenir

I am in...

It is...

You can...

I can't wait to...

REVIEW

Exit ticket

Exit ticket

Choose the correct meaning: 'nationality'

a a type of food

b the country you legally
belong to

c a tourist attraction

Exit ticket

What does 'tourist attraction' mean?

a

a place visitors like to see

b

a type of currency

c

a national dish

Exit ticket

Kasia _____ Polish.

a am

b is

c are

Exit ticket

We _____ from the same country.

a isn't

b aren't

c am not

Exit ticket

In Baku, you _____ see the Flame Towers.

a can

b is

c are

Exit ticket

Zoltán _____ speak Turkish, but he can speak English.

a can't

b isn't

c don't

Exit ticket

In 'My New Pen Pal from Poland', what is the capital of Poland?

a Kraków

b Warsaw

c Gdańsk

Exit ticket

Elif and Kasia are from the same country.

a Correct

b Incorrect

✓ **Elif is Turkish and Kasia is Polish — they aren't from the same country.**

Exit ticket

In 'International Day at Our School', what can tourists see in Baku?

a The Royal Castle

b The Flame Towers

c The Grand Bazaar

Exit ticket

_____ you speak any other languages? (soru: can)

✓ Can

Exit ticket

Warsaw _____ **the capital city of Poland. (to be)**

✓ **is**

Exit ticket

Which word means 'a person's home country/origin'?

a souvenir

b nationality

c landmark